

Euler's Phi-Function

- Euler's phi-function, $\phi(n)$, which is sometimes called the **Euler's totient function** plays a very **important role in cryptography**.
- Finds the number of integers that are both smaller than n and relatively prime to n .
- Z_n^* contains the number that are smaller than n and relatively prime to n , where as phi-function calculates the number of elements in the set.
 1. $\phi(1) = 1$
 2. $\phi(p) = p - 1$ if p is a prime.
 3. $\phi(m \times n) = \phi(m) \times \phi(n)$ if m and n are relatively prime.
 4. $\phi(p^e) = p^e - p^{e-1}$ if p is a prime.

Euler's Phi-Function

We can combine the above four rules to find the value of $\phi(n)$. For example, if n can be factored as

$$n = p_1^{e_1} \times p_2^{e_2} \times \dots \times p_k^{e_k}$$

then we combine the third and the fourth rule to find

$$\phi(n) = (p_1^{e_1} - p_1^{e_1-1}) \times (p_2^{e_2} - p_2^{e_2-1}) \times \dots \times (p_k^{e_k} - p_k^{e_k-1})$$

It is important that the calculation of phi-values for large composites can be found only if the number n can be factored into primes.

The difficulty of finding $\phi(n)$ depends on the difficulty of finding the factorization of n .

Interesting point: If $n > 2$, the value of $\phi(n)$ is even.

Example What is the value of $\phi(13)$? **Solution:** Because 13 is a prime, $\phi(13) = (13 - 1) = 12$.

Example What is the value of $\phi(10)$? **Solution:** We can use the third rule: $\phi(10) = \phi(2) \times \phi(5) = 1 \times 4 = 4$, because 2 and 5 are primes.

Example What is the value of $\phi(240)$? **Solution:** We can write $240 = 2^4 \times 3^1 \times 5^1$. Then

$$\phi(240) = (2^4 - 2^3) \times (3^1 - 3^0) \times (5^1 - 5^0) = 64$$

Example Can we say that $\phi(49) = \phi(7) \times \phi(7) = 6 \times 6 = 36$?

Solution: No. The third rule applies when m and n are relatively prime. Here $49 = 7^2$. We need to use the fourth rule: $\phi(49) = 7^2 - 7^1 = 42$.

Example What is the number of elements in Z_{14}^* ?

Solution: The answer is $\phi(14) = \phi(7) \times \phi(2) = 6 \times 1 = 6$. The members are 1, 3, 5, 9, 11, and 13.

Fermat's Little Theorem

It's a special math shortcut that only works for PRIME numbers!

Version 1: When a is NOT divisible by p

If p is prime and a is any number NOT divisible by p , then:

$$a^p - 1 \equiv 1 \text{ mod } p$$

▪ **In simple words:**

Take any number a , raise it to power $(p - 1)$, divide by prime $p \rightarrow$ remainder is always **1**.

Example 1:

$p = 5$ (prime)

$a = 2$ (not divisible by 5)

$2^{5-1} = 2^4 = 16$

$16 \text{ mod } 5 = 1$

...Fermat's Little Theorem

Version 2: Works for ALL numbers a

For ANY integer a and prime p :

$$a^p \equiv a \pmod{p}$$

- It is helpful for quickly finding a solution to some exponentiations and in finding some multiplicative inverses- some times.

Example: $a = 4, p = 3$

LHS: $4^3 = 64$

$64 \bmod 3 = 21$ remainder 1

RHS: $4 \bmod 3 = 1$ Same remainder!

Finding Modular Inverses

The inverse of a modulo p is a^{p-2}

$$a^{-1} \pmod{p} = a^{p-2} \pmod{p}$$

Example: Find $4^{-1} \pmod{7}$:

$$4^{-1} \equiv 4^{7-2} = 4^5 \pmod{7}$$

$$= (4^2) \pmod{7} (4^2) \pmod{7} (4^1) \pmod{7}$$

$$= (2 \times 2 \times 4) \pmod{7} = 16 \pmod{7} = 2$$

Verify: $4 \times 2 = 8 \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$

This modular inverse method works only when the modulus p is a prime number. For generalized cases we can use extended Euclidean

Example Find the result of $6^{10} \bmod 11$.

$$\text{Hint: } a^{p-1} \equiv 1 \bmod p$$

Solution: We have $6^{10} \bmod 11 = 1$. This is the **first version of Fermat's little theorem** where $p = 11$.

Example Find the result of $3^{12} \bmod 11$.

Solution: Here the exponent (12) and the modulus (11) are not the same. With substitution this can be solved using Fermat's little theorem.

$$\text{Hint: } a^p \equiv a \bmod p \quad \text{Here } p = 11.$$

$$3^{12} \bmod 11 = (3^{11} \times 3) \bmod 11 = (3^{11} \bmod 11) (3 \bmod 11) = (3 \times 3) \bmod 11 = 9$$

Example Find the remainder when 5^{123} is divided by 13. (OR find $5^{123} \bmod 13$)

Solution:

Step 1: Identify Prime Modulus

$p = 13$ (prime)

$a = 5$ (not divisible by 13)

Fermat's Little Theorem states:

$$a^{p-1} \equiv 1 \pmod{p}$$

For $a = 5, p = 13$:

$$5^{12} \equiv 1 \pmod{13}$$

This reduces the exponent problem significantly.

Step 2: Break Down the Large Exponent

We need 5^{123} , but FLT gives us $5^{12} \equiv 1$.

Divide 123 by 12:

$$123 = 10 \times 12 + 3$$

So, we can group 5^{123} into blocks of 5^{12} , each congruent to 1.

Step 3: Apply Exponent Rules

$$5^{123} = 5^{12 \times 10 + 3} = (5^{12})^{10} \times 5^3$$

Using FLT:

$$(5^{12})^{10} \equiv 1^{10} \equiv 1 \pmod{13}$$

Thus:

$$5^{123} \equiv 1 \times 5^3 \pmod{13}$$

Step 4: Final Simplification

$$5^3 = 125$$

Compute $125 \bmod 13$:

$$125 \bmod 13 = 8$$

So:

$$125 \equiv 8 \pmod{13}$$

Final Answer:

8

Multiplicative Inverses

Example

The answers to multiplicative **inverses modulo a prime** can be found **without using the extended Euclidean algorithm**:

Find $7^{-1}(\text{mod}13)$

Solution:

Step 1: Verify Conditions

$p = 13$ (prime)

$a = 7$

Since , $\text{gcd}(7,13)=1$, the inverse exists.

Step 2: Apply Fermat's Theorem Formula

Fermat's Little Theorem for a prime p :

$$a^{-1} \text{ mod } p = a^{p-2} \text{ mod } p$$

Thus:

$$7^{-1} \equiv 7^{13-2} = 7^{11} \pmod{13}$$

Multiplicative Inverses

Solution:

Step 3: Compute $7^{11} \bmod 13$ via Repeated Squaring

Break $11 = 8 + 2 + 1$:

Compute powers modulo 13:

$$7^1 = 7$$

$$7^2 = 49 \equiv 10 \pmod{13}$$

$$7^4 \equiv 10^2 = 100 \equiv 9 \pmod{13}$$

$$7^8 \equiv 9^2 = 81 \equiv 3 \pmod{13}$$

Combine:

$$7^{11} = 7^8 \times 7^2 \times 7^1 \equiv 3 \times 10 \times 7$$

$$3 \times 10 = 30 \equiv 4 \pmod{13}$$

$$4 \times 7 = 28 \equiv 2 \pmod{13}$$

So:

$$7^{-1} \equiv 2 \pmod{13}$$

Step 4: Verification

$$7 \times 2 = 14 \equiv 1 \pmod{13}$$

Confirmed.

Practice Exercise :

1. Find $3^{64} \bmod 41$
2. Find $9^{-1}(\bmod 19)$
3. Find $12^{-1}(\bmod 29)$

Practice Exercise 1 solution:

1. Find $3^{64} \bmod 41$

Apply Fermat's Little Theorem

Since $\gcd(3, 41) = 1$, $3^{40} \equiv 1 \pmod{41}$.

Reduce the exponent

$$3^{64} = 3^{40} \times 3^{24}$$

$$3^{64} \equiv 3^{24} \pmod{41}.$$

Compute $3^{24} \bmod 41$

$$3^2 = 9$$

$$3^4 = 81 \equiv -1 \pmod{41}$$

$$3^8 = (-1)^2 \equiv 1 \pmod{41}$$

$$3^{16} \equiv 1 \pmod{41}$$

$$3^{24} = 3^{16} \times 3^8 \equiv 1 \times 1 \equiv 1 \pmod{41}$$

Final Answer:

$$3^{64} \equiv 1 \pmod{41}$$

Euler's Theorem

Think of it as Fermat's Theorem for ANY number!

Fermat's Theorem: Works only for Modulus is **prime number** and base & modulus are coprime

Euler's Theorem: Works for Modulus is **any positive number** and base & modulus are coprime

Version 1: When a and n are co-prime

If , then:

$$a^{\phi(n)} \equiv 1 \pmod{n}$$

In simple words:

Take any number a that shares no factors with n , raise it to power $\phi(n)$,divide by $n \rightarrow$ remainder is **1**.

Euler's Theorem

Version 2: The RSA Connection

If $n = p \times q$ (product of two primes), then:

$$a^{k \times \phi(n) + 1} \equiv a \pmod{n}$$

k is an integer

This is the mathematical heart of RSA encryption!

- Used to secure internet communications
- Makes online banking and messaging private

Example Find the remainder when 2^{50} is divided by 11.

Solution:

Step 1: Verify Conditions

$$n = 11$$

$$a = 2 \text{ (coprime)}$$

Euler's theorem applies .

Step 2: Apply Euler's Totient Function

For a prime p :

$$\phi(p) = p - 1$$

So:

$$\phi(11) = 10$$

Step 3: Use Euler's Theorem Formula

Euler's theorem states:

Thus:

$$2^{10} \equiv 1 \pmod{11}$$

Step 4: Simplify the Large Exponent

We want $2^{50} \pmod{11}$.

$$2^{50} = (2^{10})^5$$

Step 5: Apply Euler's Result

$$(2^{10})^5 \equiv 1^5 \equiv 1 \pmod{11}$$

Therefore:

$$2^{50} \equiv 1 \pmod{11}$$

Final Answer: Remainder when 2^{50} is divided by 11 is 1

Multiplicative Inverses

Euler's theorem can be used to find multiplicative inverses modulo a composite. If n and a are coprime, then

$$a^{-1} \bmod n = a^{\phi(n)-1} \bmod n$$

Example

Find $5^{-1} \pmod{18}$

Step 1: Verify Conditions

$n = 18$ (composite)

$a = 5$, (coprime)

Inverse exists since a and n are coprime.

Step 2: Compute Euler's Totient $\phi(n)$

Prime factorization:

$$18 = 2 \times 3^2$$

Thus:

$$\phi(18) = \phi(2) \times \phi(3^2) = 1 \times (3^2 - 3^1) = 6$$

Step 3: Apply Euler's Theorem Formula

$$a^{-1} \equiv a^{\phi(n)-1} \pmod{n}$$

For $a = 5$, $n = 18$, $\phi(18) = 6$:

$$5^{-1} \equiv 5^{6-1} = 5^5 \pmod{18}$$

Multiplicative Inverses

Euler's theorem can be used to find multiplicative inverses modulo a composite. If n and a are coprime, then

$$a^{-1} \bmod n = a^{\phi(n)-1} \bmod n$$

Example

Find $5^{-1} \pmod{18}$

Step 4: Compute $5^5 \bmod 18$

$$5^2 = 25 \equiv 7 \pmod{18}$$

$$5^4 = (5^2)^2 \equiv 7^2 = 49 \equiv 13 \pmod{18}$$

$$5^5 = 5^4 \times 5 \equiv 13 \times 5 = 65 \equiv 11 \pmod{18}$$

Thus:

$$5^{-1} \equiv 11 \pmod{18}$$

Verification

$$5 \times 11 = 55$$

$$55 \div 18 = 3 \text{ remainder } 1$$

$$55 \equiv 1 \pmod{18}$$

Final Answer: 11

Practice Exercise :

1. Remainder when 5^{100} is divided by 17.
2. Remainder when 3^{75} is divided by 13.
3. Remainder when 4^{40} is divided by 9.
4. Find $17^{-1}(\text{mod}33)$
5. Find $13^{-1}(\text{mod}40)$

Practice Solution 1:

Remainder when 5^{100} is divided by 17. (OR find $5^{100} \bmod 17$)

Step 1: $n = 17$, prime, $\gcd(5, 17) = 1$.

Step 2: $\phi(17) = 16$.

So $5^{16} \equiv 1 \pmod{17}$.

Step 3: Exponent division

$100 \div 16$: quotient 6, remainder 4.

So $100 = 16 \times 6 + 4$.

Therefore:

$$5^{100} = 5^{16 \times 6} \times 5^4 = (5^{16})^6 \times 5^4.$$

Step 4: Using Euler:

$5^{16} \equiv 1$, so $(5^{16})^6 \equiv 1^6 \equiv 1$.

So $5^{100} \equiv 1 \times 5^4 \pmod{17}$.

Step 5: Compute $5^4 \bmod 17$

$5^2 = 25$, $25 \bmod 17 \equiv 8 \bmod 17$

$5^4 = 8 \times 8 = 64$, $64 \bmod 17 \equiv 13 \bmod 17$.

So remainder = **13**.